

SEPARATION PROCESSES II

CHE F313 · BITS Pilani · I-Semester 2026-27

Short Notes & Formula Sheet

Module 1 — Properties and Handling of Particulate Solids (Ch. 28)

Module 2 — Mechanical Separations (Ch. 29)

Compiled from: Module 1 Lectures 1–6 and Module 2 Lectures 1–2 — the course slide decks (Mod1-Lecture 1-5.pptx, Mod1-Lecture 6-compressed.pdf, Mod 2-Lecture 1-compressed.pdf, Mod 2-Lecture 2.pptx).

Reference texts: McCabe, Smith & Harriott, *Unit Operations of Chemical Engineering*, 7e (Ch. 28, 29); Swain, Patra & Roy, *Mechanical Operations*, Tata McGraw Hill.

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Notation used throughout

D_p	particle diameter (equivalent or nominal)	A_w	specific surface area of the mixture (m^2/kg)
$\bar{D}_s$	volume-surface (Sauter) mean diameter	N_w	number of particles per unit mass
$\bar{D}_v$	volume mean diameter	N_i, N_T	particles in fraction i , total number
$\bar{D}_N$	arithmetic (number) mean diameter	x_i	mass fraction of fraction i
$\bar{D}_w$	mass mean diameter	a	volume shape factor, $v_p = aD_p^3$
Φ_s	sphericity of the particle	W_i	Bond work index (kW h/short ton)
ρ_p	density of the particle	η_c, η_m	crushing, mechanical efficiency
s_p, v_p	surface area, volume of one particle	ε	porosity of the bed / cake

MODULE 1 · LECTURE 1 — Introduction and Characterisation of Solid Particles

Why particulate solids matter

- Solids are more difficult to handle than liquids or gases; of all the shapes and sizes found in solids, the small particle is the most important from a chemical-engineering standpoint.
- Designing processes and equipment for streams containing solids needs an understanding of the characteristics of masses of particulate solids.
- Most important properties of pieces of solids: density (mass per unit volume), hardness (resistance to scratching), fragility (how easily a particle crumbles), tenacity (resistance to collisions).

Characterisation: size, shape and density

- Every particle is characterised by size D_p , shape and density ρ_p .
- **Density:** particles of homogeneous solids have the same density as the bulk material; particles from a composite solid (e.g. metal-bearing ore) have various densities, usually different from the bulk.
- **Size:** for regular (equidimensional) particles size and shape are easily specified (spheres, cubes); non-equidimensional particles are characterised by the *second longest major dimension*; for needle-like particles D_p refers to the thickness, not the length; for irregular particles (sand grains, mica flakes) size and shape must be defined arbitrarily.
- **Equivalent (nominal) diameter:** the size of a spherical particle having the same controlling characteristic as the particle considered. The controlling characteristic depends on the system and the process:

- surface area controls (irregular catalyst particle) → surface diameter D_{ps} ;
- mass/volume controls (gravitational free settling in a liquid) → volume diameter D_{pv} ;
- both area and volume control → volume–surface (Sauter) diameter D_{vs} .

$$\begin{aligned}
 \text{Surface diameter: } s_p &= \pi D_{ps}^2 & \Rightarrow D_{ps} &= \sqrt{\frac{s_p}{\pi}} \\
 \text{Volume diameter: } v_p &= \frac{\pi D_{pv}^3}{6} & \Rightarrow D_{pv} &= \left(\frac{6v_p}{\pi}\right)^{1/3} \\
 \text{Sauter diameter: } D_{vs} &= \frac{6v_p}{s_p} & \Rightarrow \frac{s_p}{v_p} &= \frac{\pi D_{vs}^2}{\pi D_{vs}^3/6} = \frac{6}{D_{vs}} \\
 \text{Sphericity: } \Phi_s &= \frac{6v_p}{D_p s_p} & \Rightarrow \Phi_s &= 1 \text{ for a sphere}
 \end{aligned}$$

Screen-average size: $D_p = \frac{1}{2}(\text{aperture of the screen it passes} + \text{aperture of the screen that retains it})$

Sphericity = (surface-area-to-volume ratio of a sphere of the same diameter) ÷ (surface-area-to-volume ratio of the particle). It is independent of particle size and is tabulated for common shapes in Table 28.1 of the text. For granular materials the exact v_p and s_p cannot be measured, so D_p is the nominal size from screen analysis or microscopy.

Size ranges and measurement

- Coarse particles: inches or millimetres; fine: screen size; very fine: micrometres or nanometres; ultrafine: sometimes described by surface area per unit mass (m^2/g).
- Screening $> 50 \mu\text{m}$; sedimentation and elutriation $> 1 \mu\text{m}$; permeability method $\approx 1 \mu\text{m}$.
- Instrumental analysers: electronic particle counter (Coulter counter), laser-diffraction analysers, X-ray or photo-sedimentometers, dynamic light-scattering techniques.

MODULE 1 · LECTURE 2 — Screening and Screen Analysis

Screen geometry

$$\begin{aligned}
 \text{Mesh number} &= \text{number of openings per linear inch} \\
 \text{Clear opening (inch)} &= \frac{1}{\text{mesh number}} - \text{wire thickness} \\
 p &= w + d \quad (p = \text{pitch}, w = \text{aperture width}, d = \text{wire diameter})
 \end{aligned}$$

- **Aperture width** w : distance between two adjacent warp or weft wires, measured in the projected plane at the mid positions.
- **Warp**: wires running lengthwise of the woven cloth; **weft**: wires running across.
- Standard series: BSS (British Standard Screen), IMM (Institute of Mining & Metallurgy), U.S. Tyler mesh (Appendix 5 of the text), U.S. ASTM.

Notation and experimental procedure

- 14/20 means “through 14 mesh and on 20 mesh”; $-14 + 20$ means “passes 14 and is retained on 20”.
- Minus (–) material / undersize passes the screen; plus (+) material / oversize is retained on it.
- A set of standard screens is stacked with the smallest mesh at the bottom and the largest at the top. The sample goes on the top screen and the stack is shaken mechanically for a definite time (~ 20 min). Each increment is removed and weighed, and the masses are converted to mass fractions or percentages of the total sample. Particles passing the finest screen are caught in the bottom pan.

The standard screen series

$$\begin{aligned}
 \text{Base: } &\text{opening of the 200-mesh screen} = 0.074 \text{ mm} \\
 \text{Ratio: } &\text{area of the openings of a screen} = 2 \times \text{area of the next smaller screen} \\
 &\Rightarrow \text{mesh-dimension ratio} = \sqrt{2} = 1.41 \\
 \text{Intermediate screens: } &\text{mesh dimension} = \sqrt[4]{2} = 1.189 \text{ times the next smaller standard screen}
 \end{aligned}$$

Differential vs cumulative analysis

- **Differential analysis** tabulates the mass (or number) fraction in each size increment against the average particle size (or size range) of the increment.
- **Cumulative analysis** adds the individual increments consecutively, starting with the increment containing the smallest particles, and plots the cumulative sums against the maximum particle diameter of the increment.
- Methods based on the cumulative analysis are more precise in principle, since the assumption that all particles in a fraction are of equal size is not needed; measurement accuracy rarely justifies it, so calculations are nearly always based on the differential analysis.
- For mixtures of particles of various sizes and densities: sort the mixture into fractions of constant density and approximately constant size, weigh each fraction (or count the particles), apply the area and number equations to each fraction and add the results.

MODULE 1 · LECTURE 3 — Mixed Particle Sizes: Derivations and Average Diameters

Basis

- A sample of uniform particles of diameter D_p is separated into a number of fractions, each fraction i consisting of particles of average size D_{pi} and constant density ρ_p .
- m = total mass of the sample; m_i = mass of the i -th fraction; $x_i = m_i/m$ = mass fraction of the i -th increment.
- Other symbols: v_p = volume of one particle, s_p = surface area of one particle, N = number of particles.

Step 1 — surface area and specific surface area

$$\begin{aligned} (1) \quad \text{Sphericity:} \quad \Phi_s &= \frac{6v_p}{D_p s_p} & \implies \quad s_p &= \frac{6v_p}{D_p \Phi_s} \\ (2) \quad \text{Number of particles:} \quad N &= \frac{m}{\rho_p v_p} \\ (3) \quad \text{Total surface area:} \quad A &= N s_p = \frac{m}{\rho_p v_p} \cdot \frac{6v_p}{\Phi_s D_p} = \frac{6m}{\rho_p \Phi_s D_p} \\ (4) \quad \text{Area of the } i\text{-th fraction:} \quad A_i &= \frac{6m_i}{\rho_p \Phi_s D_{pi}} \\ (5) \quad \text{Specific surface area:} \quad \frac{A_i}{m_i} &= \frac{6}{\rho_p \Phi_s D_{pi}} \\ (6) \quad \text{Net specific surface area} \quad A_w &= \frac{6x_1}{\rho_p \Phi_s D_{p1}} + \frac{6x_2}{\rho_p \Phi_s D_{p2}} + \dots = \frac{6}{\rho_p \Phi_s} \sum_{i=1}^n \frac{x_i}{D_{pi}} \\ (7) \quad A_w &= \frac{6}{\Phi_s \rho_p \overline{D}_s} \\ (8) \quad \text{Volume-surface (Sauter) mean:} \quad \overline{D}_s &= \frac{1}{\sum_{i=1}^n \frac{x_i}{D_{pi}}} = \frac{6}{\Phi_s \rho_p A_w} \end{aligned}$$

Step 2 — number of particles (volume shape factor)

- Write the volume of a particle as $v_p = aD_p^3$, where a is the **volume shape factor** ($a = \pi/6$ for a sphere); a is constant and independent of size.

$$\begin{aligned}
(9) \quad N &= \frac{m}{a\rho_p D_p^3} \\
(10) \quad N_i &= \frac{m_i}{a\rho_p D_{pi}^3} && \text{(the } i\text{-th fraction)} \\
(11) \quad \frac{N_i}{m_i} &= \frac{1}{a\rho_p D_{pi}^3} && \text{(specific number)} \\
(12) \quad N_w &= \frac{1}{a\rho_p} \sum_{i=1}^n \frac{x_i}{D_{pi}^3} && \text{(particles per unit mass)} \\
(13) \quad N_w &= \frac{1}{a\rho_p \bar{D}_v^3} && \Rightarrow \bar{D}_v = \left[\frac{1}{\sum x_i / D_{pi}^3} \right]^{1/3} = \left(\frac{1}{N_w a\rho_p} \right)^{1/3}
\end{aligned}$$

Summary of average particle sizes (from the slides)

$$\text{Sauter (volume-surface): } \bar{D}_s = \frac{6}{\Phi_s \rho_p A_w} = \frac{1}{\sum_{i=1}^n \frac{x_i}{D_{pi}}}$$

$$\text{Volume mean: } \bar{D}_v = \left[\frac{1}{\sum x_i / D_{pi}^3} \right]^{1/3}$$

$$\text{Arithmetic mean: } \bar{D}_N = \frac{\sum N_i D_{pi}}{\sum N_i} = \frac{\sum N_i D_{pi}}{N_T}$$

$$\text{Mass mean: } \bar{D}_w = \sum_{i=1}^n x_i D_{pi}$$

$$\text{Particles per unit mass: } N_w = \frac{1}{a\rho_p} \sum_{i=1}^n \frac{x_i}{D_{pi}^3}$$

MODULE 1 · LECTURE 4 — Particulate Masses: Properties, Storage, Conveying, Mixing

Properties of particulate masses

- Masses of dry, non-sticky solid particles have many of the properties of a fluid, but differ as follows:
 - the pressure is not the same in all directions;
 - a shear stress applied at the surface of a mass is transmitted throughout a static mass of particles unless failure occurs;
 - the density of the mass varies with the degree of packing of the grains;
 - before a tightly packed mass can flow it must increase in volume, so that interlocking grains can move past one another;
 - when granular solids are piled on a flat surface the sides of the pile are at a definite reproducible angle with the horizontal (angle of repose; the related angle of internal friction is also used).
- By flow properties, particulate solids are divided into **non-cohesive** materials (grain, dry sand, plastic chips) that flow readily out of a bin or silo, and **cohesive** solids (wet clay) characterised by reluctance to flow through openings.

Bulk storage, bins and silos

- Coarse solids (gravel, coal) are stored outside in large piles unprotected from the weather; outdoor storage can cause dusting or leaching of soluble material. Solids too valuable or too soluble to expose are stored in bins, hoppers or silos.
- In a bin or silo the lateral pressure exerted on the walls at any point is *less* than that predicted from the head of material above that point.
- Wall-solid friction, whose effect is felt throughout the mass because of interlocking, offsets the weight of the solid and reduces the pressure on the floor; the vertical pressure on the floor or packing support is much smaller than that of a column of liquid of the same density and height.
- Solids are best discharged through an opening in the floor: flow through a side opening is uncertain, increases

the lateral pressure on the other side while flowing, and a bottom outlet is less likely to clog and does not induce abnormally high wall pressures.

Conveying

- Belt conveyors and bucket elevators, closed-belt conveyors with zipper-like fasteners, drag and flight conveyors — all include a return leg carrying the empty belt or chain from the discharge back to the loading point.
- Vibrating, pneumatic and screw conveyors have no return leg but operate only over relatively short distances.

Mixing of solids — statistical measures of mixer performance

- Mixing of solids, free-flowing or cohesive, resembles to some extent the mixing of low-viscosity liquids: two or more separate components are intermingled to form a more or less uniform product. Some equipment used for blending liquids can occasionally be used for solids.
- Mixing is harder to define for solids and pastes than for liquids; quantitative measures are based on statistical procedures applied to spot samples taken from the mix at various times. A mixture in which one component is randomly distributed through another is said to be **completely mixed**.

Granular non-cohesive solids — N spot samples, each of n particles:

$$s = \sqrt{\frac{\sum_{i=1}^N (x_i - \bar{x})^2}{N - 1}} \quad \text{standard deviation of the sample analyses}$$

$$\sigma_e = \sqrt{\frac{\mu_p(1 - \mu_p)}{n}} \quad \text{theoretical s.d. for a completely random mixture}$$

$$I_s = \frac{\sigma_e}{s} \quad \text{mixing index (increases as mixing proceeds)}$$

Cohesive solids and pastes — mass fractions instead of numbers:

$$\sigma_0 = \sqrt{\mu(1 - \mu)} \quad \text{theoretical s.d. at zero mixing}$$

$$I_s = \frac{\sigma_0}{s} \quad \text{mixing index for pastes}$$

x_i = fraction of component A in each sample (number fraction for non-cohesive, mass fraction for cohesive); $\bar{x}$ = average of the measured fractions; μ_p = overall number fraction of A in the mixture; μ = overall mass fraction of A. s diminishes towards zero and I_s increases as mixing proceeds, so a low s (high I_s) means good mixing.

MODULE 1 · LECTURE 5 — Size Reduction (Comminution)

Purpose, mechanisms, influencing factors

- Cutting or breaking solids into smaller pieces is called **comminution**. Reasons: to get a workable size, to increase reactivity, to separate unwanted ingredients by mechanical methods, to handle and dispose easily.
- Objectives: increase the surface area, because in most chemical reactions and some unit operations (drying, adsorption, leaching) the reaction or transfer is directly proportional to the area of contact between the solid and the second phase; produce particles of the desired shape, size or size range and specific surface; separate unwanted particles effectively; dispose of solid wastes easily; mix solid particles more intimately; improve handling, storage and transportation characteristics.
- **Mechanisms**: compression (nutcracker — coarse reduction of hard solids, very few fines); impact (hammer — coarse, medium and fine products); attrition or rubbing (file — very fine products); cutting or shear (a pair of shears — definite particle size with few or no fines).
- **Properties of solids affecting size reduction**: hardness (affects power consumption and wear of the machine); toughness (resistance to impact, the reverse of friability or brittleness); structure (granular, e.g. coal or rock, or fibrous); friability (tendency to fracture during normal handling); moisture content; explosive nature (must be ground wet or in an inert environment); soapiness (a low coefficient of friction of the surface makes crushing more difficult); heat sensitivity (heat generated during size reduction can cause loss of heat-sensitive components).
- **Process factors**: moisture and sticky material in the equipment feed; fines in the feed; segregation of feed particles in the crushing chamber; lack of feed control; wrong motor size; insufficient crusher discharge area; insufficient capacity of the crusher discharge conveyor; extremely hard material; surface energy of solids; power consumption; selection of an appropriate crushing chamber.

Energy and power requirement

- The cost of power is a major expense in crushing and grinding. During size reduction the feed particles are first distorted and strained; the work to strain them is stored temporarily in the solid as mechanical energy of stress, like energy in a coiled spring. As more force is applied the particles distort beyond their ultimate strength and suddenly rupture into fragments, generating new surface.
- Since a unit area of solid has a definite surface energy, creating new surface requires work, supplied by the release of stress energy when the particle breaks. By conservation of energy, all stress energy in excess of the new surface energy created must appear as heat.

$$\text{Crushing efficiency: } \eta_c = \frac{\text{surface energy created}}{\text{energy absorbed by the solids}} = \frac{e_s(A_{wb} - A_{wa})}{W_n}$$

$$\text{Mechanical efficiency: } \eta_m = \frac{\text{energy absorbed by solids}}{\text{total energy input}} = \frac{W_n}{W}$$

$$\text{Hence } W = \frac{W_n}{\eta_m} = \frac{e_s(A_{wb} - A_{wa})}{\eta_c \eta_m}$$

e_s = surface energy per unit area (J/m²); A_w = specific surface area (m²/kg): A_{wb} product, A_{wa} feed; W_n = energy absorbed by unit mass of material (J/kg).

$$\text{Power required by the machine } (\dot{m} = \text{feed rate}): P = \dot{m}W = \frac{6\dot{m}e_s}{\eta_c \eta_m \rho_p} \left[\frac{1}{\Phi_{sb} \overline{D}_{sb}} - \frac{1}{\Phi_{sa} \overline{D}_{sa}} \right]$$

using $A_w = \frac{6}{\Phi_s \overline{D}_s \rho_p}$ for product (b) and feed (a), with $\rho_a = \rho_b = \rho_p$.

The three empirical laws

- **Rittinger (1867)**: the work required in crushing is proportional to the new surface created.
- **Kick (1885)**: the work required for crushing a given mass of material is constant for the same reduction ratio = (initial particle size)/(final particle size).
- **Bond (1952)**: the work required to form particles of size D_p from a very large feed is proportional to the square root of the surface-to-volume ratio of the product.

$$\text{Rittinger: } \frac{P}{\dot{m}} = K_R \left[\frac{1}{\overline{D}_{sb}} - \frac{1}{\overline{D}_{sa}} \right], \quad K_R = \frac{6e_s}{\Phi_s \rho_p} \quad (1/K_R = \text{Rittinger's number})$$

valid for fine grinding, feed < 0.05 mm with $\Phi_{sb} = \Phi_{sa}$

$$\text{Kick: } \frac{P}{\dot{m}} = K_k \ln \frac{\overline{D}_{sa}}{\overline{D}_{sb}}$$

$$\text{Bond: } \frac{P}{\dot{m}} \propto \sqrt{\frac{s_p}{v_p}} = \sqrt{\frac{6}{\Phi_s D_p}} = K \sqrt{\frac{6}{\Phi_s}} \sqrt{\frac{1}{D_p}} = \frac{K_b}{\sqrt{D_p}}$$

$$\frac{P}{\dot{m}} = K_b \left[\frac{1}{\sqrt{D_{pb}}} - \frac{1}{\sqrt{D_{pa}}} \right]$$

$$\xrightarrow[\text{very large feed}]{1/\sqrt{D_{pa}} \rightarrow 0} \frac{P}{\dot{m}} = \frac{K_b}{\sqrt{D_{pb}}}, \quad K_b = 0.3162 W_i$$

$$\frac{P}{\dot{m}} = 0.3162 W_i \left[\frac{1}{\sqrt{D_{pb}}} - \frac{1}{\sqrt{D_{pa}}} \right] \quad (D_p \text{ in mm, } P \text{ in kW, } \dot{m} \text{ in tonne/h})$$

K_b = Bond constant, depends on the type of machine and on the material being crushed; $K_b = W_i \sqrt{100 \times 10^{-6}} = 0.3162 W_i$, which follows from the 100 μm definition of W_i . Both Kick's and Rittinger's laws apply to limited ranges of particle size.

Work index and the generalised law

- **Work index W_i** : the gross energy requirement in kilowatt-hours per short ton (2000 lb) of feed needed to reduce a very large feed to such a size that 80% of the product passes a 100 μm screen; units kW h per short ton. 1 short ton = 2000 lb = 908 kg.
- Work indices include friction in the crusher (Table 28.2 of the text). For dry grinding W_i should be multiplied by 4/3.

Generalised differential law: $dW = d\left(\frac{P}{\dot{m}}\right) = -K \frac{d\bar{D}_s}{\bar{D}_s^n}$

$$n = 1 \rightarrow \text{Kick: } W = -K \ln \bar{D}_s = K \left\{ \ln \frac{1}{\bar{D}_{sb}} - \ln \frac{1}{\bar{D}_{sa}} \right\} = K \ln \frac{\bar{D}_{sa}}{\bar{D}_{sb}}$$

$$n = 2 \rightarrow \text{Rittinger: } W = K \left[\frac{1}{\bar{D}_{sb}} - \frac{1}{\bar{D}_{sa}} \right]$$

$$n = 3 \rightarrow \text{Bond: } W = K \left[\frac{1}{\sqrt{\bar{D}_{pb}}} - \frac{1}{\sqrt{\bar{D}_{pa}}} \right]$$

(Integration used throughout: $\int x^n dx = \frac{x^{n+1}}{n+1} + C$.)

MODULE 1 · LECTURE 6 — Equipment for Size Reduction

Classification of size-reduction equipment

The classification follows the method by which the force is applied:

- **Impact:** impact at one surface; impact between particles.
- **Compression:** crushing; grinding.
- **Rubbing / attrition** between surfaces.
- **Shear / cutting** of the solid.
- **Non-mechanical** introduction of energy: thermal shock; explosive shattering; electrohydraulic crushing; cryogenic crushing; ultrasonic crushing.

Equipment classes (by size of feed and product)

Class	Duty	Typical sizes
Crushers	heavy work of breaking large pieces of solid material into small lumps	<i>primary:</i> operates on run-of-mine material, accepting anything that comes from the run-of-mine face and breaking it into 150–250 mm lumps; <i>secondary:</i> reduces lumps to perhaps 6 mm
Grinders	reduce crushed feed to powder	<i>intermediate:</i> product might pass a 40-mesh screen; <i>fine:</i> most of the product passes a 200-mesh screen with a 74 μm opening
Ultrafine grinders	very fine powders	accepts feed no larger than 6 mm; product typically 1–50 μm
Cutting machines	particles of definite size and shape	2–10 mm in length

Principal types of size-reduction machines

A. Crushers (coarse and fine)	1. jaw crushers; 2. gyratory crushers; 3. crushing rolls
B. Grinders (intermediate and fine)	1. hammer mills, impactors; 2. rolling-compression mills (a. bowl mills, b. roller mills); 3. attrition mills; 4. tumbling mills (a. rod mills, b. ball and pebble mills, c. tube and compartment mills)
C. Ultrafine grinders	1. hammer mills with internal classification; 2. fluid-energy mills; 3. agitated mills; 4. colloid mills
D. Cutting machines	1. knife cutters, dicers, slitters

Selection criteria for size-reduction equipment

- It should produce the material of the desired shape and size, or the desired size distribution; accept the maximum input size expected; have a large capacity; and not choke or plug.
- It should pass unbreakable material without damaging itself, and operate economically with minimum supervision and maintenance.
- The power input per unit weight of product should be small, and it should resist abrasive wear.
- It should be dependable, with a prolonged service life, and its replacement parts should be readily available at a cheap price.
- The initial fixed cost and the operating cost should be minimum; it should be easy and safe to operate, with easy access to internal parts for maintenance.

Crushers

- Types: jaw crushers, gyratory crushers, smooth-roll crushers, toothed-roll crushers. Principle: *compression*, to break large lumps of very hard materials. Applications: mining, cement manufacture and large-scale operations.
- **Working principle (jaw / gyratory):** a conical crushing head gyrates inside a funnel-shaped casing that is open at the top; an eccentric drives the shaft carrying the crushing head; solids caught between the head and the casing are broken and re-broken until they pass out at the bottom.
- **Smooth-roll crushers:** secondary crushers producing a product 1–12 mm in size; they are limited by the size of the particle that can be *nipped* by the rolls, and the feed ranges in size from 12 to 75 mm.

Grinders (intermediate size-reduction duty; the product from a crusher is fed to a grinder)

- Types: hammer mills and impactors; rolling-compression machines; attrition mills; tumbling mills (ball mill).
- **Hammer mills and impactors:** a high-speed rotor turns inside a cylindrical casing, usually with the shaft horizontal; feed dropped into the top of the casing is broken and falls out through a bottom opening; the particles are broken by sets of swing hammers.
- **Roller mills:** solids are caught and crushed between vertical cylindrical rollers and a stationary anvil ring or bull ring; the rotors are driven at moderate speeds in a circular path; plows lift the solid lumps from the floor of the mill and direct them between the ring and the rolls; a stream of air sweeps the product to a classifier-separator, and oversized particles are returned to the mill for further reduction. Applications: reduction of limestone, cement clinker and coal.
- **Attrition mills; tumbling (ball) mills** — in a ball mill most of the reduction is done by *impact*.

Critical speed of a ball mill (revolutions per second):

$$n_c = \frac{1}{2\pi} \sqrt{\frac{g}{R-r}}$$

g = acceleration due to gravity (m/s^2); R = radius of the mill (m); r = radius of the grinding elements (m).

The operating speed must be *less* than the critical speed — usually 65–80 % of it, and lower for wet grinding in viscous suspensions.

Ultrafine grinders

- Many commercial powders must contain particles averaging 1–20 μm , with substantially all the particles passing a standard 325-mesh screen whose openings are 44 μm wide. Mills that reduce solids to such fine particles are called **ultrafine grinders**.
- Ultrafine grinding of dry powder is done by grinders such as high-speed hammer mills provided with internal or external classification, and by fluid-energy or jet mills. Ultrafine *wet* grinding is done in agitated mills.
- **Fluid-energy (jet) mills:** the particles are suspended in a high-velocity gas stream. In some designs the gas flows in a circular or elliptical path; in others jets oppose one another or vigorously agitate a fluidized bed. Some reduction occurs when particles strike or rub against the walls of the confining chamber, but most of the reduction is believed to be caused by *interparticle attrition*. Internal classification keeps the larger particles in the mill until they are reduced to the desired size.

Cutting machines

In some size-reduction problems the feed stocks are too tenacious or too resilient to be broken by compression, impact or attrition; in others the feed must be reduced to particles of fixed dimensions. These requirements are met by devices that cut, chop or tear the feed into a product with the desired characteristics.

Equipment operation

A crusher, grinder or cutter cannot be expected to perform satisfactorily unless

1. the feed is of suitable size and enters at a uniform rate;
2. the product is removed as soon as possible after the particles are of the desired size;
3. unbreakable material is kept out of the machine; and
4. in the reduction of low-melting or heat-sensitive products, the heat generated in the mill is removed.

Open-circuit and closed-circuit operation

- **Open circuit:** the feed is broken into particles of satisfactory size by passing it once through the mill; no attempt is made to return oversize particles to the machine for further reduction. This may require excessive amounts of power, because much energy is wasted in regrounding particles that are already fine enough.

- **Closed circuit:** the term applied to the action of a mill and a separator connected so that the oversize particles are returned to the mill.

Energy consumption and heat removal

- Size reduction is probably the most inefficient of all unit operations: over 99 % of the energy goes into operating the equipment and producing undesirable heat and noise, leaving less than 1 % for creating new surface.
- As processes have been developed that require finer and finer particles as feed to a kiln or reactor, the total energy requirement has increased — reduction to very fine sizes is much more costly in energy than simple crushing to relatively coarse products. Energy consumed per tonne rises steeply as the product size falls (special mills $\gg$ ball mills $>$ rod mills $>$ crushers).
- Only a very small fraction of the energy supplied to the solid is used in creating new surface; the bulk is converted to heat, which may raise the temperature of the solid by many degrees. The solid may melt, decompose or explode unless this heat is removed. Cooling water or refrigerated brine is often circulated through coils or jackets in the mill; sometimes the air blown through the mill is refrigerated, or solid carbon dioxide (dry ice) is admitted with the feed; still more drastic temperature reduction is achieved with liquid nitrogen, giving grinding temperatures below -75°C . The purpose of such low temperatures is to alter the breaking characteristics of the solid, usually by making it more friable.

MODULE 2 · LECTURE 1 — Screening and Screen Effectiveness

Mechanical separations — scope

- Mechanical separations are applicable to *heterogeneous mixtures*, not to homogeneous solutions; the techniques are based on physical differences between the particles such as size, shape or density.
- They are applicable to separating solids from gases, liquid drops from gases, solids from solids and solids from liquids.
- General methods of mechanical separation:
 - the use of a sieve (screening), septum or porous membrane (filtration) — such as a screen or a filter — which retains one component and allows the other to pass;
 - utilisation of differences in the rate of sedimentation of particles or drops as they move through a liquid or a gas;
 - utilisation of surface, electrical or magnetic properties of particles.

Screening

- Screening is a method of separating particles *according to size alone*. In industrial screening the solids are dropped on, or thrown against, a screening surface; the undersize (fines) pass through the screen openings while the oversize (tails) do not.
- Applications: mining and mineral processing, food, chemical, agriculture, plastics, recycling and pharmaceuticals.
- Screening is done with the help of screening equipment. Particles drop through the openings with the help of gravity; in a few machines they are pushed through by a brush or by centrifugal force. Coarse particles can easily drop through large openings in a stationary surface, but fine particles need to be agitated in order to pass.
- There are two methods of agitation: **shaking** and **gyrating**. Motions used in practice: gyrations in the horizontal plane; gyrations in the vertical plane; gyrations at one end with shaking at the other; shaking; mechanically vibrated; electrically vibrated; stationary inclined screens and grizzlies.
- Screening equipment: stationary screens and grizzlies (for the coarse feed from a primary crusher), gyrating screens and vibrating screens.

Ideal and actual screens

- **Objective of a screen:** to accept a feed containing a mixture of particles of various sizes and separate it into two fractions — oversize and undersize; both may be products.
- **Ideal screen:** would sharply separate the feed mixture in such a way that the smallest particle in the overflow is just larger than the largest particle in the underflow.
- **Cut diameter D_{pc}** marks the point of separation between the fractions and is chosen close to the mesh opening of the screen.
- Actual screens do *not* give perfect separation about the cut diameter. A commercial screen gives poorer separation, whereas a testing screen gives good separation. For a 10-mesh screen the opening is 1.651 mm, so

oversize is $> 1.651 \text{ mm}$ and undersize $< 1.651 \text{ mm}$.

Material balance over a screen

F = mass flow rate of feed, D = overflow, B = underflow

x_F, x_D, x_B = mass fraction of *oversize* particles in feed, overflow, underflow

$1 - x_F, 1 - x_D, 1 - x_B$ = the corresponding mass fractions of *undersize*

Overall material balance: $F = D + B$ (1)

Oversize material balance: $Fx_F = Dx_D + Bx_B$ (2)

Eliminating B : $Fx_F = Dx_D + (F - D)x_B \implies F(x_F - x_B) = D(x_D - x_B)$

$$\implies \boxed{\frac{D}{F} = \frac{x_F - x_B}{x_D - x_B}} = \frac{\text{overflow mass flow rate}}{\text{feed mass flow rate}} \quad (3)$$

Eliminating D : $Fx_F = (F - B)x_D + Bx_B \implies F(x_F - x_D) = B(x_B - x_D)$

$$\implies \boxed{\frac{B}{F} = \frac{x_F - x_D}{x_B - x_D}} = \frac{\text{underflow mass flow rate}}{\text{feed mass flow rate}} \quad (4)$$

Screen effectiveness

- Screen effectiveness measures the success of a screen in closely separating oversize (A) and undersize (B) particles.
- If the efficiency were 100%, all of D would report to the overflow and all of B to the underflow.

$$E_A = \frac{\text{oversize material in overflow}}{\text{amount of A in feed}} = \frac{Dx_D}{Fx_F}$$

$$E_B = \frac{\text{undersize material in underflow}}{\text{amount of B in feed}} = \frac{B(1 - x_B)}{F(1 - x_F)}$$

Combined overall effectiveness $E = E_A E_B = \frac{Dx_D}{Fx_F} \cdot \frac{B(1 - x_B)}{F(1 - x_F)} = \frac{D}{F} \frac{B}{F} \frac{x_D}{x_F} \frac{1 - x_B}{1 - x_F}$

Replacing D/F and B/F from (3) and (4), the product $\frac{x_F - x_B}{x_D - x_B} \cdot \frac{x_F - x_D}{x_B - x_D}$ rearranges to $\frac{(x_F - x_B)(x_D - x_F)}{(x_D - x_B)^2}$, so that

$$E = \frac{x_D}{x_F} \frac{1 - x_B}{1 - x_F} \frac{(x_F - x_B)(x_D - x_F)}{(x_D - x_B)^2}$$

The same result may also be written as

$$E = \frac{x_D}{x_F} \frac{x_F - x_B}{x_D - x_B} \left[1 - \frac{1 - x_D}{1 - x_F} \frac{x_F - x_B}{x_D - x_B} \right]$$

(In the slide's written form the denominator appears as $(x_B - x_D)^2$; since it is squared this is the same as $(x_D - x_B)^2$.)

MODULE 2 · LECTURE 2 — Filtration

Definition, driving force, classification

- **Filtration** is the removal of solid particles from a fluid by passing the fluid (slurry) through a filtering medium (a porous septum) on which the solids are deposited. Industrial filtration ranges from simple straining to highly complex separations. The fluid may be a liquid or a gas; the valuable stream may be the fluid, or the solids, or both — and sometimes neither, as when waste solids must be separated from waste liquid before disposal.
- The fluid flows through the medium by virtue of a pressure differential across it: pressure above atmospheric on the upstream side of the medium, a vacuum on the downstream side, or gravity. In a gravity filter the medium can be no finer than a coarse screen or a bed of coarse particles such as sand.
- Filters are divided into three main groups: **cake filters**, **clarifying filters** and **crossflow filters**.
 - *Cake filter*: at the start some particles enter the pores of the medium and are immobilised, but soon others collect on the septum surface. After this brief initial period the cake of solids does the filtration, not the septum; a visible cake of appreciable thickness builds up on the surface and must be periodically removed.
 - *Clarifying (depth) filter*: removes small amounts of solids to produce a clean gas or sparkling clear liquids

such as beverages. The particles are trapped inside the medium, whose pores are much larger in diameter than the particles to be removed.

- *Crossflow filter*: the feed suspension flows under pressure at fairly high velocity across the medium; a thin layer of solids may form but the high velocity keeps it from building up. The medium is a ceramic, metal or polymer membrane with pores small enough to exclude most suspended particles; clear liquid passes through, leaving a concentrated suspension behind.

Filter media and filter aids

- A filter medium must: retain the solids to be filtered, giving a reasonably clear filtrate; not plug or blind; be chemically resistant and physically strong enough to withstand the process conditions; permit the cake to discharge cleanly and completely; not be prohibitively expensive.
- Common medium: canvas cloth, duck or twill weave. Corrosive liquids require woollen cloth, metal cloth of monel or stainless steel, glass cloth or paper. Synthetic fabrics (nylon, polypropylene, various polyesters) are also highly resistant chemically.
- Slimy or very fine solids are difficult to filter because they form a dense, impermeable cake that quickly plugs the medium; the porosity of the cake must be increased so that the filtrate flows at a reasonable rate.
- **Filter aids** are generally granular or fibrous solids which form a highly permeable cake — diatomaceous silica, perlite, purified wood cellulose or other inert porous solids. Properties: low bulk density, porous, chemically inert to the filtrate. They may be used as a precoat or mixed directly with the slurry before filtration.

Principles of cake filtration

- Flow resistances increase with time as the medium clogs or a cake builds up. The quantities of interest are the flow rate through the filter and the pressure drop across the unit.
- **Constant-pressure filtration**: the pressure drop is held constant and the flow rate is allowed to fall with time. **Constant-rate filtration**: the pressure drop is progressively increased.
- The liquid passes through two resistances in series — that of the cake and that of the filter medium. The medium resistance, the only resistance in clarifying filters, is normally important only during the early stages of cake filtration; the cake resistance is zero at the start and increases with time. If the cake is washed after filtering, both resistances are constant during washing and the medium resistance is usually negligible.
- Rate of filtration depends on: the pressure drop across cake and medium; the resistance of the cake; the resistance of the medium; the area of the filtering surface; the viscosity of the filtrate.

Pressure drop through a filter cake

$$\begin{aligned}
 &\text{Darcy-type dependence: } v_0 \propto \Delta P \quad \text{and} \quad v_0 \propto \frac{1}{L} \\
 &\text{Kozeny–Carman (laminar, } Re < 1\text{): } \frac{\Delta P}{L} = \frac{150 \bar{v} \mu (1 - \varepsilon)^2}{g_c \Phi_s^2 D_p^2 \varepsilon^3} \\
 &\text{Burke–Plummer (turbulent, } Re > 1000, \text{ purely empirical): } \frac{\Delta P}{L} = \frac{1.75 \rho \bar{v}^2 (1 - \varepsilon)}{g_c \Phi_s D_p \varepsilon^3} \\
 &\text{Ergun (entire range of flow rates — viscous loss + kinetic-energy loss): } \frac{\Delta P}{L} = \underbrace{\frac{150 \bar{v} \mu (1 - \varepsilon)^2}{g_c \Phi_s^2 D_p^2 \varepsilon^3}}_{\text{viscous}} + \underbrace{\frac{1.75 \rho \bar{v}^2 (1 - \varepsilon)}{g_c \Phi_s D_p \varepsilon^3}}_{\text{kinetic energy}}
 \end{aligned}$$

$\bar{v}$ = superficial velocity, ε = bed/cake porosity, Φ_s = sphericity, D_p = particle diameter, μ = fluid viscosity, ρ = fluid density, g_c = conversion factor. The section through the medium and cake shows the fluid pressure P falling from P_a at the upstream face of the cake to P_e at the cake–medium interface and on to P_b through the medium, plotted against the distance L from the medium.

PRACTICE PROBLEMS FROM THE SLIDES

1 · Screen analysis of a clay catalyst (Lec. 3)

Finely divided clay used as a catalyst in the petroleum industry: density 1.2 g/cm^3 , sphericity 0.5. Size analysis:

D_{pi} / mm	0.0252	0.0178	0.0126	0.0089	0.0038
x_i (g/g)	0.088	0.178	0.293	0.194	0.247

- Show the differential and cumulative screen analysis of the mixture.

- Find the specific surface area A_w and the Sauter mean diameter of the clay.
- Find the number of particles in a 1 g sample.

Use $A_w = \frac{6}{\rho_p \Phi_s} \sum \frac{x_i}{D_{pi}}$ with D_{pi} in mm and ρ_p in g/mm³ ($1.2 \text{ g/cm}^3 = 1.2 \times 10^{-3} \text{ g/mm}^3$), then $\bar{D}_s = 1 / \sum \frac{x_i}{D_{pi}}$ and $N_w = \frac{1}{a \rho_p} \sum \frac{x_i}{D_{pi}^3}$.

2 · Screen analysis of crushed quartz (Lec. 3)

The screen analysis applies to a sample of crushed quartz. Density of the particles 2650 kg/m³ (0.002 65 g/mm³); shape factors $a = 0.8$ and $\Phi_s = 0.571$. For the material between 4-mesh and 200-mesh, calculate:

- A_w in mm²/g and N_w in particles per gram,
- $\bar{D}_v$, (c) $\bar{D}_s$, (d) $\bar{D}_w$,
- N_i for the 150/200-mesh increment,
- the fraction of the total number of particles in the 150/200-mesh increment.

3 · Mixing index in a muller mixer (Lec. 4)

A silty soil containing 14% moisture was mixed in a large muller mixer with 10 wt% of a tracer consisting of dextrose and picric acid. After 3 min of mixing, 12 random samples were taken and analysed colorimetrically for tracer material. Measured concentrations (wt% tracer):

10.24	9.30	7.94	10.24	11.08	10.03
11.91	9.72	9.20	10.76	10.97	10.55

Calculate the mixing index I_p and the standard deviation.

4 · Crusher power by Rittinger's law (Lec. 5)

Particles of average feed size $50 \times 10^{-4} \text{ m}$ are crushed to an average product size of $10 \times 10^{-4} \text{ m}$ at the rate of 20 t/h. At this rate the crusher consumes 40 kW, of which 5 kW is required for running the mill empty. Calculate the power consumption if 12 t/h of this product is crushed to $5 \times 10^{-4} \text{ m}$ size in the same mill. Assume Rittinger's law is applicable.

Net power = 40 – 5 = 35 kW for the first duty; K_R is found from that duty, then the new size range and feed rate are substituted. The empty-mill power is added back at the end.

5 · Screen effectiveness of a quartz mixture (Mod 2, Lec. 1)

A quartz mixture with the screen analysis below is screened through a standard 10-mesh screen (opening 1.651 mm), so the cut diameter is $D_{pc} = 1.651 \text{ mm}$. Calculate the mass ratios of the overflow and the underflow to the feed, and the overall effectiveness of the screen.

Cumulative fraction <i>larger</i> than D_p				
Mesh	D_p / mm	Feed	Overflow	Underflow
4	4.699	0	0	
6	3.327	0.025	0.071	
8	2.362	0.15	0.43	0
10	1.651	0.47	0.85	0.195
14	1.168	0.73	0.97	0.58
20	0.833	0.885	0.99	0.83
28	0.589	0.94	1.00	0.91
35	0.417	0.96		0.94
65	0.208	0.98		0.975
Pan		1.00		1.00

Reading the table at the cut size ($D_p = 1.651 \text{ mm}$, 10 mesh) gives $x_F = 0.47$, $x_D = 0.85$, $x_B = 0.195$. Then $\frac{D}{F} = \frac{x_F - x_B}{x_D - x_B} = 0.42$, $\frac{B}{F} = 1 - \frac{D}{F} = 0.58$ (check: $\frac{D}{F} x_D + \frac{B}{F} x_B = 0.470 = x_F$ ✓), $E_A = \frac{D}{F} \frac{x_D}{x_F} = 0.76$, $E_B = \frac{B}{F} \frac{1 - x_B}{1 - x_F} = 0.88$, and $E = E_A E_B = 0.67$, i.e. about 67%.

Prepared from the Module 1 (Lectures 1–6) and Module 2 (Lectures 1–2) slide decks of the course. Results follow the notation used on the slides; where a slide carried a hand-worked derivation, the intermediate steps are reproduced above. Symbols: D_p particle diameter, D_{pc} cut diameter of a screen, F , D , B feed, overflow and underflow mass flow rates, x_F ,

x_D, x_B mass fractions of oversize in feed, overflow and underflow, E_A, E_B, E screen effectiveness, n_c ball-mill critical speed, Φ_s sphericity, ρ_p particle density, s_p surface area of a particle, v_p volume of a particle, x_i mass fraction, N_i particles in a fraction, N_T total number, A_w specific surface area, N_w particles per unit mass, a volume shape factor, W_i work index, η_c crushing efficiency, η_m mechanical efficiency, ε bed porosity, K_R, K_k, K_b the Rittinger, Kick and Bond constants.